

Promises and Pressure: Pressure Builds

承诺与压力：压力上升

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The cost of the renegotiated roles arrived as a **letter**. The three of them had promised to **be** at every Thursday meeting; by the third week, one of them was not there. “I cannot **be** in two places,” Lin said. “This is not a **gesture**. I am telling you what is true.” His **grandmother** was in hospital, and the **trial** of the new care plan fell in the same week.

Maya took the minutes alone for three weeks. “The **majority** of the work is invisible,” she wrote. “A **trustee** of a small thing is a **guardian** of other people's time.” She was **sure** of one point only: a promise that depends on one person is not a promise, it is a hope. Her **will** was stronger than his schedule, and both of them knew it.

A **man** from the **mill**, an **old** friend of his **grandfather**, came to the house on the **eve** of the funeral and spoke about **trust**. “Your **grandfather** was a **radical**,” he said. “He burned the **lease** in the yard, and three families kept their homes because of it.” It was a **model** of a certain kind of courage, and it was also a warning.

At the **grave**, an **uncle** and two aunts stood with the children. “Yes,” his **auntie** said, “he was a **proper witness** to a bad century.” A **violent** storm came up, and the **Medicare** papers in his bag got wet. “You cannot **substitute** a plan for a person,” his mother said. “That is the **profound** part, and it is the part nobody writes down.”

He went **back** to the dormitory and wrote himself a note: do not **lose** the thread, and do not **bribe yourself** with busyness. A **desperate** week is not a failure; it is a **critical** week, and **judgment** is easy from the outside. His **peer** group — a **friendly** cyclist and a young woman from the third floor — offered to **guard** the Thursday slot. “The **return will be slow**,” Maya said. “**Be sure that** it happens. Ask **yourself** what you would **tackle first** if you had one clear **shot** at it.” All of those promises were still on the board when he left. “I hear you,” he said, “and here is what I can carry.” Him, of all people, she trusted. People came and went; the ones who stayed were the ones who said honestly what they could hold. He wanted to see whether the promise would hold. He watched the others go **away** down the corridor and understood that obedience to a timetable is not the same as loyalty.

中文翻译

重新商定的角色带来的代价，以一封信的形式到来。他们三人承诺出席每一次周四会议；到第三周，其中一人没有出现。“我不能同时在两个地方，”林伟说，“这不是姿态。我是在告诉你事实。”他祖母住院了，而新照料方案的试行正好落在同一周。

曼雅独自记录了三周的会议纪要。“大部分工作是看不见的，”她写道，“一件小事的受托人，是别人时间的监护人。”她只确定一点：一个依赖某一个人的承诺不是承诺，而是希望。她的意志比他的时间表更强，两人都明白这一点。

一位来自磨坊的男人，他祖父的老朋友，在葬礼前夜来到家里，谈起信任。“你祖父是个激进分子，”他说，“他在院子里烧掉了租约，三户人家因此保住了住处。”这是某类勇气的典范，同时也是一记警告。

在墓旁，一位叔父和两位姑母与孩子们站在一起。“是的，”他的姨妈说，“他是一个糟糕世纪的合格见证人。”一场猛烈的风暴袭来，他包里的医保文件被打湿了。“你不能用一个计划替代一个人，”他母亲说，“那才是深刻的部分，也正是没人写下来的部分。”

他回到宿舍，给自己写了一张纸条：不要丢掉线索，也不要忙忙碌碌来贿赂自己。绝望的一周不是失败，而是关键的一周；而从外面看，判断总是容易的。他的同伴们——一位友善的骑车人和三楼的一位年轻女士——主动提出替他守周四那一班。“回报会很慢，”曼雅说，“务必让它发生。问问你自己：如果只有一次干净的机会，你会先抓住哪件事？”他离开时，所有这些承诺都还写在白板上。“我听到了，”他说，“而这是我能承担的部分。”她信任的是他，偏偏是他。人来来去去；留下来的，是那些诚实说出自己能拿多少的人。他想看看这个承诺能不能守住。他望着其他人沿着走廊走远，明白了一件事：服从一张时间表，并不等于忠诚。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
be bi: POS: v	v. 是, 表示, 在; [计] 后端, 总线允许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have the quality of being; (copula, used with an adjective or a predicate noun); v. be identical to; be som...
will wil POS: n	n. 意志, 决心, 意愿, 意向, 干劲, 遗嘱; vt. 用意志的力量驱使, 决意, 愿意, 立遗嘱; vi. 下决心, 愿意; aux. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a fixed and persistent intent or purpose; n. a legal document declaring a person's wishes regarding the dis...
man mæn POS: n	n. 男人, 人类, 人; vt. 为...配备人手, 操纵, 使振奋; [计] 城域网, 手册 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adult person who is male (as opposed to a woman); n. the generic use of the word to refer to any human b...
back bæk POS: a	a. 后面的; vt. 使后退, 支持; vi. 倒退, 背靠; adv. 向后地; n. 背部, 后面 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the posterior part of a human (or animal) body from the neck to the end of the spine; n. the part of someth...
old əʊld POS: n	n. 以前, 往昔; a. 老的, 旧的, 古老的, 年长的, 老练的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. past times (especially in the phrase 'in days of old'); a. (used especially of persons) having lived for a...
away ə'wei POS: adv	adv. 离去 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. not present; having left; a. used of an opponent's ground; s. (of a baseball pitch) on the far side of home...
lose lu:z POS: vt	vt. 遗失, 损失, 丢失, 使失去, 错过, 浪费, 迷失, 使迷路, 输去, 使沉溺于; vi. 受损失, 失败 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. fail to keep or to maintain; cease to have, either physically or in an abstract sense; v. fail to win; v. su...
sure ʃʊə POS: a	a. 确信, 必然的, 必定的; adv. 当然, 确实地, 无疑地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. physically secure or dependable; s. (of persons) worthy of trust or confidence; s. infallible or unfailing; s...
return ri'tɜ:n POS: n	n. 回来, 返回, 来回票, 归还, 报答, 利润率, 报告书; a. 返回的, 回程的, 报答的, 反向的, 重现的, 复原的; vi. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a coming to or returning home; n. the occurrence of a change in direction back in the opposite direction; n. ...
letter 'lete POS: n	n. 信, 字母, 证书, 字面意义, 铅字, 学问, 出租人; vt. 写字母于, 在...上刻字母, 用字母标明; vi. 写印刷体字; [... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a written message addressed to a person or organization; n. the conventional characters of the alphabet use...
model 'mɒdəl POS: n	n. 模型, 模范, 模特儿; a. 模范的, 作模型用的; vi. 做模型, 做模特儿; vt. 使模仿, 塑造; [计] 模型 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hypothetical description of a complex entity or process; n. a type of product; n. a person who poses for a...
trial 'traɪəl POS: n	n. 审判, 试验, 艰苦, 麻烦事, 考验; a. 审讯的, 试验性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. trying something to find out about it; n. (law) the determination of a person's innocence or guilt by due p...
yourself jʊə'self POS: pron	pron. 你自己 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. An emphasized or reflexive form of the pronoun of the; second person; — used as a subject commonly w...
majority mə'dʒɔ:riti POS: n	n. 多数, 大半; [计] 多数逻辑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the property resulting from being or relating to the greater in number of two parts; the main part; n. (ele...
shot ʃɒt POS: n	n. 发射, 炮弹, 射击, 射手, 投篮, 射门, 子弹, 射程, 拍摄, 注射; vt. 装弹, 使成颗粒状; a. 杂色的, 交织着的, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a solid missile discharged from a firearm; n. a chance to do something; n. a person who shoots (usually with...
critical 'kritikəl POS: a	a. 批评的, 决定性的, 危险的, 临界的; [医] 危象的; 临界的, 极期的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by a tendency to find and call attention to errors and flaws; a. at or of a point at which a propert...
trust trʌst POS: n	n. 信任, 信赖, 相信, 受托, 职责, 信心, 托拉斯; a. 信托的, 托拉斯的; vt. 信赖, 信任, 相信, 盼望, 赠卖给; v... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something (as property) held by one party (the trustee) for the benefit of another (the beneficiary); n. th...
guard gɑ:d POS: n	n. 守卫者, 警戒, 护卫队, 防护装置; vt. 保卫, 看守, 当心; vi. 防止, 警惕, 警卫, 看守 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who keeps watch over something or someone; n. the person who plays that position on a football tea...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
burn bə:n POS: vt	vt. 烧, 烧毁, 烧伤; vi. 燃烧, 发热, 烧毁; n. 烧伤, 烙印 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. pain that feels hot as if it were on fire; n. an injury caused by exposure to heat or chemicals or radiation...
proper 'prɒpə POS: a	a. 适当的, 固有的, 高尚的, 专属的; adv. 完全地, 彻底地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. marked by suitability or rightness or appropriateness; s. having all the qualities typical of the thing specified...
judgment 'dʒʌdʒmənt POS: n	n. 裁判, 宣告, 判决书; [医] 判断 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an opinion formed by judging something; n. the act of judging or assessing a person or situation or event; n...
witness 'wɪtnɪs POS: n	n. 证人, 目击者, 证据, 证词; vt. 目击, 作证, 证明, 表明; vi. 作证人, 作为证据 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who sees an event and reports what happened; n. testimony by word or deed to your religious faith; n...
mill mɪl POS: n	n. 压榨机, 磨坊, 制造厂; vt. 碾磨, 磨细, 搅拌, 使乱转; vi. 乱转, 被碾磨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Scottish philosopher who expounded Bentham's utilitarianism; father of John Stuart Mill (1773-1836); n. Eng...
violent 'vaɪələnt POS: a	a. 暴力的, 猛烈的, 激烈的, 极端的, 凶暴的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. acting with or marked by or resulting from great force or energy or emotional intensity; s. effected by force...
friendly 'frendli POS: a	a. 友好的, 亲切的, 互助的; adv. 友善地, 温和地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. troops belonging to or allied with your own military forces; a. characteristic of or befitting a friend; s...
uncle ˈʌŋkl POS: n	n. 叔父, 伯父, 姨丈 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the brother of your father or mother; the husband of your aunt; n. a source of help and advice and encouragement...
radical 'rædɪkl POS: n	n. 激进分子, 词根, 基础, 根式, 根; a. 激进的, 根本的, 基本的, 根的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who has radical ideas or opinions; n. (mathematics) a quantity expressed as the root of another quantity...
peer piə POS: n	n. 同等的人, 匹敌, 贵族; vi. 凝视, 窥视, 费力地看, 隐现; vt. 与...同等, 封为贵族 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is of equal standing with another in a group; n. a nobleman (duke or marquis or earl or viscount)...
grandmother 'grændmʌðə POS: n	n. 祖母, 女祖先 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the mother of your father or mother
aunt ɑ:nt POS: n	n. 阿姨, 姨妈, 舅妈, 姑妈, 伯母 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sister of your father or mother; the wife of your uncle
tackle 'tækl POS: n	n. 工具, 复滑车, 滑车, 装备, 扭倒; vt. 固定, 处理, 抓住; vi. 扭倒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the person who plays that position on a football team; n. (American football) a position on the line of scrimmage...
gesture 'dʒestʃə POS: n	n. 手势, 姿态; vi. 作手势, 作姿态 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. motion of hands or body to emphasize or help to express a thought or feeling; n. the use of movements (especially hand movements)...
desperate 'despəreɪt POS: a	a. 不顾一切的, 危急的, 令人绝望的, 极渴望的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is frightened and in need of help; s. desperately determined; s. (of persons) dangerously reckless...
grandfather 'grændfɑ:ðə POS: n	n. 祖父, 始祖; [电] 原始资料组 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the father of your father or mother
guardian 'gɑ:diən POS: n	n. 看守者, 监护人, 保护人; a. 保护的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a person who cares for persons or property
lease li:s POS: n	n. 租约, 租期, 租; vt. 出租, 租出, 租得 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. property that is leased or rented out or let; n. a contract granting use or occupation of property during a specified period...
grave greɪv POS: n	n. 墓穴, 坟墓, 终结, 死亡; a. 庄重的, 严肃的, 重大的, 低沉的; vt. 雕刻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. death of a person; n. a place for the burial of a corpse (especially beneath the ground and marked by a tombstone)...
trustee ,trʌs'ti: POS: n	n. 受托人, 理事; [计] 委托者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person (or institution) to whom legal title to property is entrusted to use for another's benefit
profound prə'faʊnd POS: a	a. 极深的, 深厚的, 深刻的, 渊博的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. showing intellectual penetration or emotional depth; s. of the greatest intensity; complete; s. coming from...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
substitute 'sʌbstɪtju:t POS: n	n. 代理, 代理人, 代用品, 代替者, 代替物; vt. 代替; vi. 替代, 取代, 代用; a. 代替的, 代用的, 代用品的; [计]... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person or thing that takes or can take the place of another; n. an athlete who plays only when a starter...
eve i:v POS: n	n. 前夕, 前夜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (Old Testament) Adam's wife in Judeo-Christian mythology: the first woman and mother of the human race; Go...
auntie 'ɑ:nti POS: n	n. 阿姨, 姨妈, 舅妈, 姑妈, 伯母 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the sister of your father or mother; the wife of your uncle
obedience ə'bi:djəns POS: n	n. 服从, 顺从, 忠实; [法] 服从, 顺从, 遵从 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of obeying; dutiful or submissive behavior with respect to another person; n. the trait of being wi...
bribe braɪb POS: n	n. 贿赂; vt. 贿赂, 收买; vi. 行贿 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. payment made to a person in a position of trust to corrupt his judgment; v. make illegal payments to in exc...
Medicare 'medi,keə POS: n	n. 医疗照顾方案, 医疗照顾项目; [法] 公办的医疗保险制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. health care for the aged; a federally administered system of health insurance available to persons aged 65...